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UAE Presidential Court

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Volodymyr Zelenskyy, President of Ukraine, yesterday discussed security developments in the region amid ongoing military escalation and their implications for regional and international peace and security, as well as their impact on international navigation and the global economy.

'UAE WILL PROTECT GAINS AND EMERGE STRONGER'

Vice-President underscores country's resilience

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE will safeguard its achievements and emerge stronger, with all sectors working in lockstep to deliver on a national pledge to the world, His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, said yesterday.

The Vice-President underscored the country's resilience and institutional strength amid evolving challenges. Chairing a Cabinet meeting, Sheikh Mohammed praised the high defensive readiness of the armed forces, the strong national spirit of citizens and residents, and the sense of responsibility demonstrated across government teams.

He said: "Under the leadership of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, national institutions are operating with efficiency, defence forces with professionalism, and the private sector with responsibility — all aligned with a commitment that the UAE will preserve its gains and return stronger."

PAKISTAN STEPS UP MEDIATION PUSH

Pakistan, Saudi Arabia, Egypt and Turkey yesterday held talks about trying to end the war in the Middle East.

Pakistan's Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar said the foreign minister level talks came at a "critical moment". "Our candid and constructive discussions focus on the evolving regional situation and advancing peace and stability, while strengthening our partnership and deepening cooperation," he wrote on X. **SEE ALSO P11**

Gargash stresses need for 'clear guarantees'

Dr Anwar Gargash, adviser to the UAE President, meanwhile, called for any settlement to the war to include "clear guarantees" that Iranian attacks on its neighbours will not be repeated.

In a social media post, he called for compensation for attacks on civilian and vital infrastructure. "Iran deceived its neighbours before the war about its intentions and revealed a premeditated aggression despite their sincere efforts to avoid it," he said, adding that these two paths were essential in confronting what he described as a regime that has become the primary threat to security in the Arabian Gulf.

Iran has intensified attacks across Gulf states, with the UAE targeted by 16 missiles and 42 drones in the past 24 hours.

Yemen's Houthi militants announced a second missile attack targeting Israel on Saturday, after stepping into the war earlier in the day in support of their ally Iran.

Iran's warning

Iran's parliament speaker yesterday warned the US against a ground invasion, threatening to set American troops "on fire" and step up attacks on US allies, according to Iranian official media. Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf said Iranian forces "are waiting for the arrival of American troops on the ground to set them on fire and punish their regional partners forever." He added: "Our firing continues. Our missiles are in place. Our determination and faith have increased."

SEE ALSO P5, P10-11

One month on, UAE stands firm

Highly efficient Emirati response keeps nation safe

ABU DHABI

BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

Scan the QR code for the full report on UAE's resilience a month into the conflict

One month after the launch of Iran's aggressive missile and drone attacks against the UAE and several Gulf states—beginning on February 28, 2026—targeting both civilian and military infrastructure, the contours of a complex landscape are becoming increasingly clear.

This landscape reflects an unprecedented level of military escalation, met by a highly efficient Emirati response and a firm political and diplomatic stance underscoring that the UAE's security and sovereignty are non-negotiable.

The UAE has affirmed before international forums that the attacks constitute a flagrant violation of international law and have deliberately targeted civilian infrastructure, thereby undermining energy security and global supply chains.

The UAE has emphasised that what is unfolding is not merely a military escalation, but a systematic and reckless pattern of behavior that undermines the foundations of the international order and threatens regional and global stability.

WAM

MOHAMMED BIN RASHID ATTENDS DUBAI WORLD CUP

■ His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, attended the 30th edition of the Dubai World Cup at the Meydan Racecourse on Saturday. Sheikh Mohammed said the Dubai World Cup has, over three decades, established itself as one of the world's greatest equestrian events, reflecting the UAE's long-term vision and its ability to turn bold ideas into success stories. **SEE ALSO P13 & P16**

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